



Kitchen Equipment Safety Operation Standards & Emergency Guide

YuKoLi — All Equipment Series

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1. General Kitchen Safety Principles

A commercial kitchen is a high-risk environment where heat, electricity, gas, water, and sharp tools converge. Every staff member must treat safety as a non-negotiable part of their daily routine. The following principles apply to all YuKoLi equipment and all kitchen operations.

First, maintain a clean and organized work area at all times. Spills, grease buildup, and clutter are direct causes of slips, fires, and equipment malfunctions. Clean as you go, and never allow debris to accumulate around equipment vents, gas lines, or electrical panels.

Second, never operate any equipment without proper training. If you have not been trained on a specific YuKoLi machine, do not touch it. Ask your supervisor for instruction. Untrained operation is the leading cause of accidents in commercial kitchens.

Third, report all hazards immediately. A frayed cord, a gas smell, a loose handle, or an unusual sound from a machine must be reported to the kitchen manager before the next shift begins. Do not attempt to repair equipment yourself unless you are a qualified technician.

Fourth, follow the manufacturer's instructions for every piece of equipment. YuKoLi equipment is designed with specific safety features and operating parameters. Bypassing these features, removing safety guards, or modifying equipment in any way is strictly prohibited.

Finally, never work alone in a kitchen during high-risk operations such as deep frying, gas cooking, or steam generation. Always ensure at least one other person is present who can respond in an emergency.

2. Pre-Operation Safety Checks (for ALL YuKoLi Equipment)



Before starting any YuKoLi equipment, perform the following checks. This should take no more than two minutes but can prevent serious accidents.

Visual Inspection: Examine the exterior of the equipment for any signs of damage, such as dents, cracks, loose panels, or missing parts. Check all cords, plugs, and connectors for fraying, exposed wires, or burn marks. For gas equipment, inspect the gas hose for cracks, kinks, or signs of wear.

Area Clearance: Ensure the area around the equipment is clear of flammable materials, including paper towels, cardboard, cleaning rags, plastic containers, and cooking oils stored in open containers. Maintain at least 18 inches of clearance on all sides for ventilation.

Ventilation Check: Verify that the ventilation system above the equipment is functioning. Turn on the exhaust hood before lighting any gas burner or turning on any electric heating element. Never operate high-temperature equipment without active ventilation.

Liquid Safety: Check that no water or other liquids are pooled on the floor near electrical equipment. For electric stir-fry machines, deep fryers, and rice cookers, ensure the unit is dry before plugging in. Water and electricity are a lethal combination.

Control Panel Check: Inspect all knobs, switches, and digital displays. They should be clean, dry, and responsive. Do not force a stuck knob. Report any control that feels loose, stiff, or unresponsive.

Emergency Shut-Off: Locate the emergency shut-off switch or circuit breaker for the equipment. Confirm that you can reach it quickly. For gas equipment, confirm the location of the gas shut-off valve. Every operator must know how to stop the equipment immediately.

3. Safe Operation by Equipment Category

3.1 Electric Equipment (Electric Stir-Fry Machines, Rice Cookers, Electric Deep Fryers, Electric Steamers)

Power Management: Always plug YuKoLi electric equipment directly into a grounded wall outlet. Never use extension cords, power strips, or adapters. These overload easily and cause fires. Before plugging in, ensure your hands are dry and you are standing on a dry surface.

Water Separation: Keep electric equipment at least three feet away from sinks, wash stations, and dishwashers. If water splashes onto an electrical unit, turn it off at the circuit breaker immediately. Do not touch the unit until it has been inspected by a qualified technician.

Fire Prevention: Electric heating elements can ignite grease and food debris. Clean electric stir-fry machines and deep fryers after every use. Never leave electric equipment unattended while in operation. If you must step away, turn the unit off.

Overload Protection: YuKoLi electric equipment is designed for specific voltage and amperage. Do not plug multiple high-wattage appliances into the same circuit. If a circuit breaker trips frequently, report it. This indicates an overload or a wiring issue.

Steam and Moisture: Electric steamers produce hot steam that can damage electrical components. Keep the control panel dry. Never spray water directly onto the unit for cleaning. Wipe down with a damp cloth only after the unit has cooled and been unplugged.

3.2 Gas Equipment (Gas Stir-Fry Machines, Gas Deep Fryers, Gas Braising Cookers, Gas Soup Pots)

Gas Leak Detection: Before lighting any gas burner, check for the smell of gas. Natural gas has a distinct sulfur-like odor. If you smell gas at any time, do not light any burner, do not operate any electrical switch, and do not use a phone in the area. Evacuate immediately and call the gas emergency number from outside.

Proper Lighting Procedure: Always follow the manufacturer's lighting sequence. For YuKoLi gas equipment, the standard procedure is: turn on the exhaust hood, open the gas shut-off valve, turn the burner control to the "light" position, and use a long-handled lighter or built-in igniter. If the burner does not light within five seconds, turn the gas off, wait five minutes for gas to dissipate, and try again.

Ventilation: Gas equipment produces carbon monoxide, which is deadly in enclosed spaces. Never operate gas equipment without the exhaust hood running. Ensure make-up air is provided to prevent negative pressure in the kitchen. If staff experience headaches, dizziness, or nausea, evacuate immediately—this may indicate carbon monoxide buildup.

Flame Monitoring: A proper gas flame should be blue with a stable cone. Yellow or orange flames indicate incomplete combustion. If you see yellow flames, turn the equipment off and report it. Adjust air shutters only if trained to do so.

Shut-Off Procedure: When finished, turn the burner control to "off" first, then close the gas shut-off valve. Never leave a gas burner on with no flame. Always confirm the flame is extinguished before leaving the area.

3.3 High-Temperature Equipment (Deep Fryers, Steamers, Drum Stir-Fry Machines, Top-Stir Machines, Braising Cookers)

Burn Prevention: All YuKoLi high-temperature equipment operates at temperatures exceeding 300°F (150°C). Assume all metal surfaces are hot. Use only designated handles, knobs, and controls. Never touch the cooking vessel, lid, or exhaust vents during or immediately after operation.

Oil Safety for Deep Fryers: Hot oil causes severe burns. Fill deep fryers only to the indicated fill line. Overfilling causes hot oil to overflow when food is added. Lower food baskets slowly to prevent splashing. Never leave hot oil unattended. If oil begins to smoke excessively, turn the unit off immediately—this indicates the oil is approaching its flash point.

Steam Burns: Steam causes burns more severe than boiling water. When opening steamers, noodle cookers, or braising cookers, stand to the side and open the lid away from your face. Release steam slowly. Never reach into a steamer while it is operating. Use long-handled tools to place and remove items.

Hot Surfaces: Place warning signs near hot equipment. Use heat-resistant gloves and aprons when handling hot pots, baskets, or lids. Never use wet towels or cloths to handle hot items—steam will form and burn your hands.

Cooling Down: Allow equipment to cool before cleaning. For deep fryers, allow oil to cool to below 100°F (38°C) before filtering or draining. Never pour water into hot oil—this causes an explosive grease fire.

4. Emergency Procedures



4.1 Fire Emergencies

Small Electrical Fire: If a fire starts in an electrical cord, plug, or control panel, do not use water. Water conducts electricity and causes electrocution. Immediately unplug the equipment if safe to do so. Use a Class C fire extinguisher (dry chemical) or a Class K extinguisher if the fire involves grease as well. If the fire grows, evacuate and call 911.

Gas Fire: If a gas burner flame spreads or a gas line catches fire, turn off the gas supply at the shut-off valve immediately. Do not attempt to move the equipment. Use a Class K or ABC fire extinguisher. If the fire is small and contained to the burner, covering the burner with a metal lid may smother it. If the fire is large or spreading, evacuate and call 911.

Grease Fire: A grease fire in a deep fryer or stir-fry machine is extremely dangerous. Never use water. Never move the equipment. Turn off the heat source immediately. Cover the fryer with a metal lid if possible. Use a Class K fire extinguisher specifically designed for kitchen grease fires. If the fire reaches the exhaust hood, activate the hood's fire suppression system if installed. Evacuate and call 911.

General Fire Response: Follow R.A.C.E.:

- **Rescue** anyone in immediate danger
- **Alarm:** activate the fire alarm and call 911
- **Contain:** close doors to contain the fire
- **Extinguish:** use the appropriate extinguisher only if the fire is small and you have been trained

4.2 Gas Leak

If you smell gas or hear a hissing sound from a gas line:

1. Do not light any flame or operate any electrical switch.
2. Do not use phones, flashlights, or any device that could create a spark.
3. Evacuate everyone from the kitchen immediately.
4. Close the main gas shut-off valve if you can do so safely without entering the affected area.
5. Call the gas company emergency number from outside the building.
6. Do not re-enter until the gas company or fire department declares it safe.

4.3 Electrical Shock

If a person is being electrocuted:

1. Do not touch the person with your bare hands—you will also be electrocuted.
2. Turn off the power at the circuit breaker or unplug the equipment if safe to do so.

3. If you cannot turn off the power, use a non-conductive object (dry wooden broom handle, rubber mat, or plastic chair) to push the person away from the source.
4. Once the person is free, check for breathing and pulse. Begin CPR if trained.
5. Call 911 immediately. Electrical shock can cause internal injuries even if the person appears fine.

4.4 Burns

For thermal burns from hot surfaces, oil, or steam:

1. Remove the person from the heat source.
2. Cool the burn under cool running water for at least 10 minutes. Do not use ice—it damages tissue.
3. Remove clothing or jewelry near the burn if not stuck to the skin.
4. Cover the burn with a clean, dry cloth or sterile burn dressing.
5. Do not apply butter, ointments, or ice.
6. Call 911 for severe burns (larger than the palm of the hand, on the face, hands, feet, or genitals, or if the skin is charred or white).

For chemical burns (from cleaning agents):

1. Remove contaminated clothing.
2. Flush the area with cool running water for 20 minutes.
3. Call 911 or seek medical attention immediately.

5. Lockout/Tagout Procedures

Lockout/Tagout (LOTO) is required whenever cleaning, maintenance, or repair is performed on any YuKoLi equipment. This prevents accidental startup that could cause serious injury or death.

Authorized Personnel Only: Only trained and authorized maintenance staff may perform lockout/tagout. Kitchen operators must never bypass a lockout device.

Step 1: Notify Affected Staff. Before starting, inform all kitchen staff that the equipment will be shut down for maintenance.

Step 2: Shut Down Equipment. Turn off the equipment using its normal controls.

Step 3: Isolate Energy Sources.

- For electric equipment: unplug the unit or turn off the circuit breaker.
- For gas equipment: close the gas shut-off valve.
- For steam equipment: close the steam supply valve and allow pressure to release.

Step 4: Apply Lock and Tag. Place a personal padlock on the energy isolation point. Attach a tag that states: "DO NOT OPERATE. Equipment under maintenance." The tag must include the name of the person performing the work, the date, and the expected completion time.

Step 5: Verify Isolation. Attempt to start the equipment using its normal controls. It should not start. If it does, stop immediately and re-check the isolation point.

Step 6: Perform Work. Only after verification is complete may maintenance begin.

Step 7: Remove Lockout/Tagout. After work is complete, inspect the area to ensure all tools and guards are removed. Ensure all staff are clear of the equipment. Remove the lock and tag. Restore energy sources and test the equipment.

6. PPE Requirements

All kitchen staff must wear the following personal protective equipment when operating YuKoLi equipment:

Head and Hair: Wear a clean chef hat or hairnet. Long hair must be tied back and secured. No loose hair that could contact equipment.

Eye Protection: Wear safety glasses or goggles when operating deep fryers, steamers, or when cleaning with chemicals. Steam and hot oil can cause permanent eye damage.

Hand Protection:

- Use heat-resistant gloves (rated for at least 400°F/200°C) when handling hot pots, baskets, or lids.
- Use cut-resistant gloves when cleaning or handling sharp tools.
- Never wear loose gloves near rotating equipment such as drum stir-fry machines.

Body Protection: Wear a long-sleeved chef coat made of flame-resistant material. Do not wear synthetic fabrics that melt when exposed to heat. Wear an apron that covers the front of the body.

Foot Protection: Wear slip-resistant, closed-toe shoes with non-slip soles. No sandals, clogs without back straps, or open-toed shoes. Shoes should be oil-resistant.

Jewelry and Accessories: Remove all jewelry, including rings, watches, bracelets, and necklaces. These can catch on equipment, conduct electricity, or trap heat against the skin. Remove all earrings and facial piercings.

7. Emergency Contact Template

Post this information in a visible location near the kitchen exit. Complete each field with current information.

KITCHEN EMERGENCY CONTACTS

Facility Name: _____

Address: _____

Emergency Services: 911

Local Fire Department (Non-Emergency): _____

Local Police (Non-Emergency): _____

Gas Company Emergency: _____

Electric Company Emergency: _____

Poison Control: 1-800-222-1222

YuKoLi Customer Support (Equipment Issues): _____

YuKoLi Technical Support (Gas/Electric): _____

Kitchen Management

Kitchen Manager: Name: _____ Phone: _____

Assistant Manager: Name: _____ Phone: _____

Safety Officer: Name: _____ Phone: _____

Maintenance Contact: Name: _____ Phone: _____

Gas Shut-Off Valve Location: _____

Main Electrical Panel Location: _____

Fire Extinguisher Locations:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

First Aid Kit Location: _____

Emergency Exit Routes: (Attach map or diagram)

Note to Kitchen Manager: Review this manual with all new staff during orientation. Conduct a safety drill at least once per quarter. Update emergency contact information whenever personnel changes occur. Keep a printed copy of this manual near the kitchen entrance at all times.

This manual is a general safety guide for YuKoLi commercial kitchen equipment. Always refer to the specific operator's manual provided with each machine for detailed instructions and safety warnings. No manual can cover every possible hazard. Use common sense and prioritize safety above speed or convenience.